LOUIEWOOD: From Gingoog Dirt to GLOBAL DYNASTY

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"From Hood to Hollywood: One Man's War Against the Odds"

Dedication

To the ones still stuck in the fire.
To the daughters I burn for.
To the future I refused to lose.

Epigraph

"They tried to bury me.
They didn't know I was the
seed."

Introduction: “This Ain’t a Fairytale”

This book ain’t for everyone.

It’s for the ones who had to grow up before they were ready.
The ones who know what it’s like to count coins for rice.
The ones who had to break rules just to survive a system that never gave 'em a rulebook.

My name is Francis Louie.
This is my story — raw, unfiltered, and still unfolding.

From barefoot chases through banana fields to building something real in Gingoog, I didn’t write this to inspire likes. I wrote this so no one else has to learn the hard way like I did. This book ain’t just a memoir — it’s a blueprint. For hustlers. For fathers. For fighters.

If you're reading this, you probably already know how cold the streets can get. But I need you to know one thing:
We can make fire out of that cold. We can build out of the burn.

So turn the page.
Walk through my past.
And maybe, just maybe, you’ll find your way out of yours.

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Author's Note

I almost didn't write this.
Too many ghosts. Too much shame. Too much fear that telling the truth would bring everything crashing down again.

But silence never saved anyone. And someone out there needs this more than I need my comfort.

I'm not a saint. I'm not a CEO in a suit. I'm just a man who refused to stay buried.

So I wrote this for the next me.
The kid who's staring at a bike he can't afford.
The father who doesn't know how to show up.
The hustler who knows there's gotta be more than just dodging bullets and building walls.

This book is proof.
That you can start with nothing.
And build everything.

If you make it to the last page?
You'll know exactly why the world started calling it…
Louiewood.

Chapter 1: Broken Beginnings

Gingoog City wasn't the kind of place people pointed to on a map and said, ***"That's where greatness begins."*** But for Francis Louie, it was home, a place where rusted tricycles lined the streets, the scent of sizzling carinderia meat hung in the air, and dreams felt more like whispers tossed into the wind.

If comfort was a country, he'd never crossed the border. He came from cracked floors, unfinished ceilings, and nights when the rumbling of an empty stomach drowned out the lullabies his mother once sang. Life in Northern Mindanao had its beauty, the sea kissing the shorelines, mountains standing tall in the distance, but beauty doesn't feed you. It doesn't pay bills. And it doesn't give you a second chance.



By the time Francis hit his mid-20s, it felt like he'd already lived a dozen lifetimes. He'd

become a father twice, to two daughters, born from two women who had once believed in him, even when he didn't believe in himself. Love was complicated, but fatherhood? That was real. It gave his life purpose. But direction meant nothing when you didn't have the means to move forward.

He hustled where he could — flipping second hand bike parts on Facebook, reselling cheap phone accessories from Shopee, even designing tricycle logos on his cracked Android. When his phone couldn't keep up, he'd walk to the nearest pisonet café, rent time by the peso, and grind online — anything to keep the hustle alive. Just enough to survive. Not enough to live. Every peso counted. Every dream had to wait.

One night, under a sky heavy with stars and doubt, Francis sat outside his small rented room, smoking a cheap cigarette. ***There's got to be more to life than this***. Not more luxury. Not fame. Just more ***possibilities***. A way to break free from the invisible prison of poverty.

Then came the idea. The kind of idea most people would dismiss out of fear.

Marijuana.

He'd seen it around. Smelled it in alleyways. Heard stories of people making big money, fast, but dangerous. Something about it lingered in his mind. Not because he wanted to be a criminal. Not because of the thrill. But because it was the one opportunity nobody else seemed willing to chase. Where others saw risk, he saw a chance.

What if this was the way?

But this wasn't a movie. This was real life. And in real life, people get caught. They go to jail. Or worse. In the Philippines, drug laws weren't just strict, they were deadly.

Francis knew that. And yet, he couldn't shake the thought. Not because he didn't care, but because he had no other choice. No capital for a business. No degree. No connections. Just guts. Guilt. And grit.

That night, he didn't make a decision.

But the seed was planted.

And as all seeds do, with time, pain, and care, it began to grow.